



Moto G96 5G: Imperfect...

... but also impressive for the price

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Buying a smartphone under Rs 20,000 these days can feel like both a blessing and a challenge. On one hand, there's no shortage of feature-rich options offering great value. On the other hand, picking the right one from a sea of near-identical specs and marketing buzzwords is tougher than it looks. Brands are constantly trying to push the limits by offering high-resolution displays, larger batteries and good cameras, all while keeping the price accessible.

Motorola's latest entry into this competitive space is the Moto G96 5G, with a starting price of ₹17,999. It comes with a 144Hz pOLED display, Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 chipset, a 50-megapixel main

camera, and a 5,500mAh battery. But how does it handle real-world use?

I've been using the Moto G96 5G for several days, here's my full take on its performance, camera and battery life.

Design

The Moto G96 5G comes in four Pantone-curated colours: Ashleigh Blue, Greener Pastures, Cattleya Orchid and Dresden Blue. Motorola sent us the Greener Pastures variant, a deep green shade with a matte vegan leather finish.

The texture of the vegan leather is soft to the touch and adds a bit of grip, making the phone feel secure in the hand. It has the advantage of being resistant to fingerprints and smudges,

something that's especially useful if you prefer using your phone without a case.

The phone has a clean, minimal design with a subtly raised camera module that blends into the rear panel. The Motorola logo is placed at the centre of the back panel, and overall look is clean. The G96 5G feels fairly slim and balanced, with curved edges that contribute to a comfortable in-hand feel.

Display

The Moto G96 features a 6.67-inch FHD+ 3D Curved pOLED display with a 144Hz refresh rate. This display panel is protected by Corning Gorilla Glass 5. In our brightness tests, the G96 hit 834 nits (manual) and peaked at 2170 nits in auto mode, which means great outdoor legibility even under harsh sunlight.

Using Calman and the Spectral C6 Colourimeter, we tested the colour accuracy of the display. In the natural colour profile, the G96 achieved an average Delta E of 1.5, indicating good colours that make watching content a treat. Also, the gamut coverage is nearly 100% which means the display is capable of rendering the entire range of colours. So, whether you're streaming content on YouTube or bingeing shows on your favourite OTT apps, the experience is smooth and visually pleasing.

Performance

Now, let's talk about performance. The Moto G96 5G is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 chipset, paired with 8GB of LPDDR4X RAM and up to 256GB of UFS 2.2 storage. In day-to-day use, the phone holds up well. Tasks like texting, browsing Instagram, watching YouTube or jumping between multiple apps felt smooth and lag-free. For casual gaming, the phone performs reliably, too, and titles like Temple Run run without any issues.

The numbers back it up as well. On AnTuTu, the Moto G96 5G scored 6,28,570, while the Geekbench benchmark results came in at 1,018 (single-core) and 2,939 (multi-core). These